



also mean that if your airwaves are overly cluttered, you'll have a higher chance of receiving a stronger signal in the 5GHz band, if your device supports it.

You can also pick up some wireless repeaters for around ₹2,000, and these should be able to amplify the source signal strength to acceptable levels, great for a large house or one with very thick walls.

802.11ac support might seem like an indulgence, but do consider the bandwidth required for the data that you consume, especially if you're running a home server. A single, high-quality 1080p movie alone will easily consume about 100MBps bandwidth and you're not going to be the only one trying to stream a movie to your device. In the long run, this makes a lot of sense, especially when you won't

be able to tolerate anything below 4K, and there's really no point in taking a wireless 802.11n ready router when a wireless 802.11ac router will cost just a little bit more. Don't scrimp on the things that matter, or will matter for that matter.

Sharing on-the-go

We've all had hell with Hotel Wi-Fi and Internet at some time or the other. Why should you pay extra for wireless Internet access when the wired version is free? Simply purchase a portable Wi-Fi router (costing anything between ₹1,500-₹3,000) and you're set. Plug the Ethernet cable into the device and set it up right and you will now have Wi-Fi access.



Adapt

It's frustrating to have to use a dedicated digital camera at times, if only because it lacks that convenience of instantly sharing your images and videos on social media or wherever else. Free yourself



from the shackles of the laptop and endless supply of SD cards and adapters and get yourself an SD card streamer and/or a Wi-Fi ready SD card.

Either of these devices will stream data from your camera's SD card directly to your phone or tablet, leaving you to partake of the comforts of a wireless world.

Also, you'll never run out of space at the last moment simply because you can use your own phone/tablet as a backup device.

You also do get portable HDDs with SD card readers, USB otg cables, etc. All these are also viable alternatives of course, but there's something far more convenient about a purely wireless world.

LAPTOP AND DESKTOP FIXES

Upgrade your RAM

If you find your PC to be stuttering a lot or your browser crashes regularly, it's highly probable that your system is running out of RAM. This shouldn't be a problem on systems with a bare minimum of 4GB of RAM and if you have such issues, it's indicative of a deeper problem.

A 4GB RAM stick will set you back by only about ₹2,000-4,000 depending on the type of RAM that you'll need, but the improvement in performance will be quite significant.

A word of caution though, ensure that you're taking a RAM module that's compatible with your motherboard and if you want to pair up your old module with the new one, try to get a module with identical specs because otherwise, both modules will function at the speed of the slowest one.

You need, at a minimum, to keep the following in mind:

- **Operating voltage:** This varies from 1.35V to 1.65V so check your motherboard/laptop manual.
- **Operating speed:** This is the speed at which your RAM operates. The most common frequencies are 1333-1600 MHz, though you can get modules that go to 2400 MHz and beyond.



Faster RAM is always better, but for a low-end system, quantity will matter more. Check your motherboard or laptop manual for supported speeds and also, the sticker on your existing RAM module, which should have all the specs.

- **Timing:** Again, Google the numbers printed on the sticker attached to your existing memory module to know the exact timing. This is another important factor that will determine your RAM module's performance. It's usually designated by a set of numbers like 999-12 or CL9, etc. The exact style will depend on your RAM module, so if you don't know what you're doing, cross-check with someone who does or research a little on your own.

Get an SSD

An SSD might sound like a really expensive indulgence, but prices have steadily declined over the years and you can get a 128 GB drive for under ₹5,000 very easily.